MEETING 3

Islamic, Universal & Other Values in AI Ethics

- Religious Values in AI
- *& Bab ADAB (Slide Courtesy PM Dr Noor Azurati)*
- Related Policy, Legal, & Regulator
- Conceptualizing Resolution of AI Ecosystems for Human Flourishing

(Some are in form of these activities: Lecture, Discussion, Case Studies, Short Quiz, Self Study)

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SAIA 1013: Responsible AI and Ethics

MEETING 3
SECTION 01

Course Lecturer: Dr. Nurazean Maarop
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Teaching Plan Meeting 3

Class engagement session Online Lecture

Independent Further Study (Forum):

Material: Read further about Religious Value & Conceptualizing Resolution of AI Ecosystems for Human Flourishing notes.
Task: Identify principle that integrates Islamic, universal, or other values to promote responsible AI. Identify and explain one example context where there is conflict between responsible AI and ADAB.
Output for forum: Share your proposed resolution and explain how it promotes human flourishing in the AI ecosystem.

Study for TEST (15%):

Do Revision for TEST Preparation to be held in Week 4, after the morning lecture session.
Test (15%)
Topic Cover: Module Week 1 - 3
Date : 25th August 2025 (2.15pm – 3.30 pm)
Venue: Booking in progress (Dewan Tan Sri Ainuddin Wahid
Question Structure:
Objective (5%): 10 Questions, Subjective (10%): 3 Questions each from Module 1-3

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Ethics and Religion

- Throughout human history and evolution, religion has been found to be one of the most important and comprehensive social institutions, touching and shaping almost all areas of culture and society

- Religion provides humans with a frame of reference for the organization of live in general, whether individual or group

- The religious beliefs of each individual and how strong their religious belief are, are important aspects in the formation of personal and social identity

Ethics is influenced by cultural and religious values

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Beliefs Shape AI Ethics

- Personal Belief: Individual religious or cultural values influencing ethical decisions.
- Ethics: often overlap with personal beliefs but aim for universal applicability form a framework relevant to all religious.
- Stewardship: humans are caretakers (khalifah) of the Earth and its resources. Are we human responsible stewards of AI technology?

The Difference Between Ethics and Laws

- **Conflicts?**:

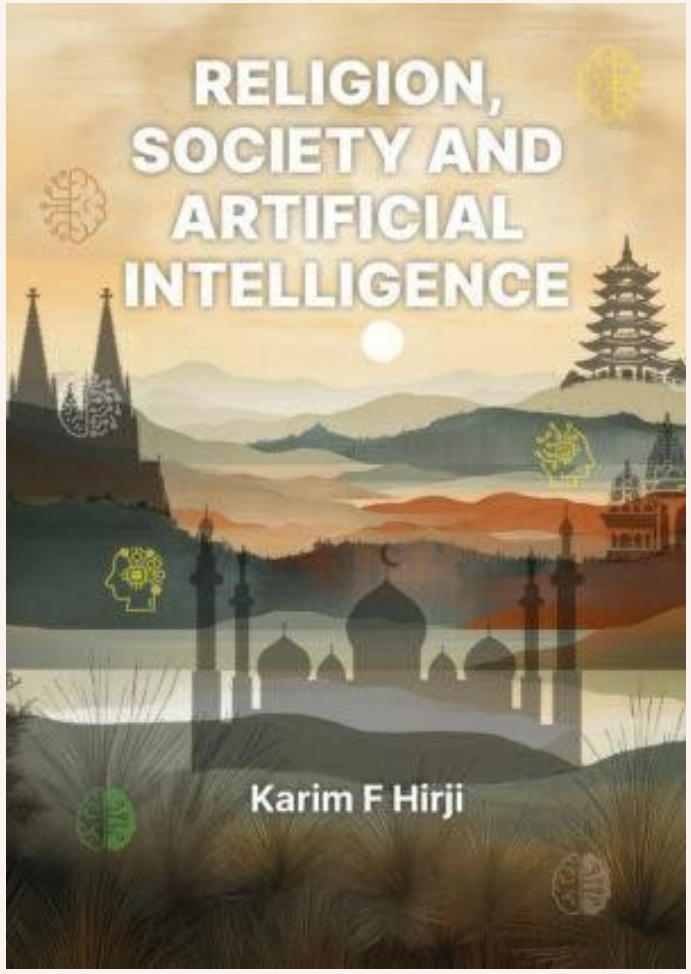
  Sometimes, any example in general context?
- **Ethics**:

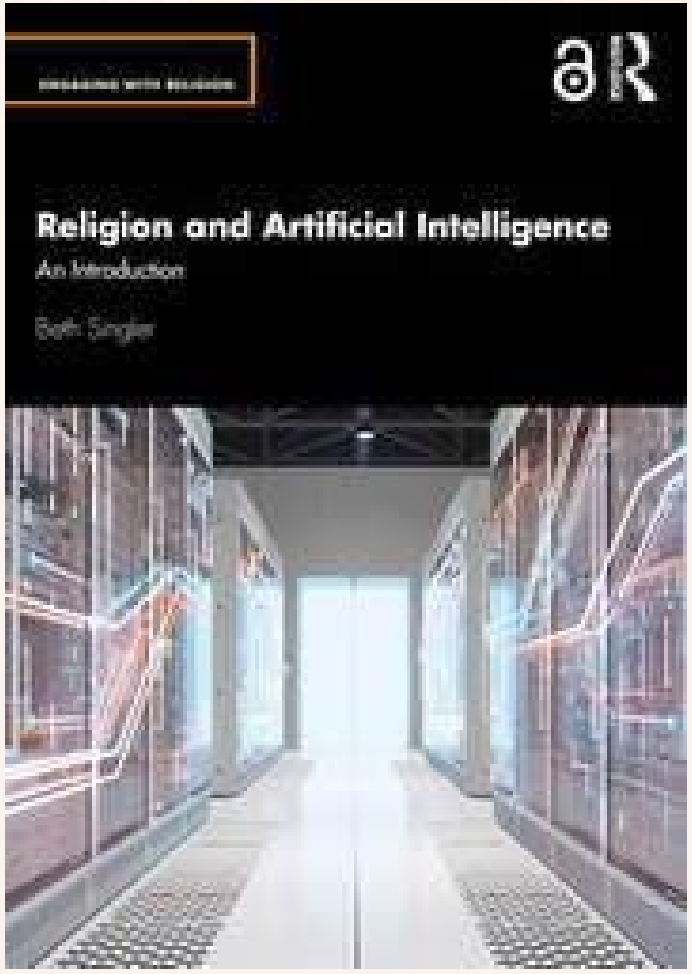
  Standards or codes of behaviour expected of an individual by a group
- **Law**:

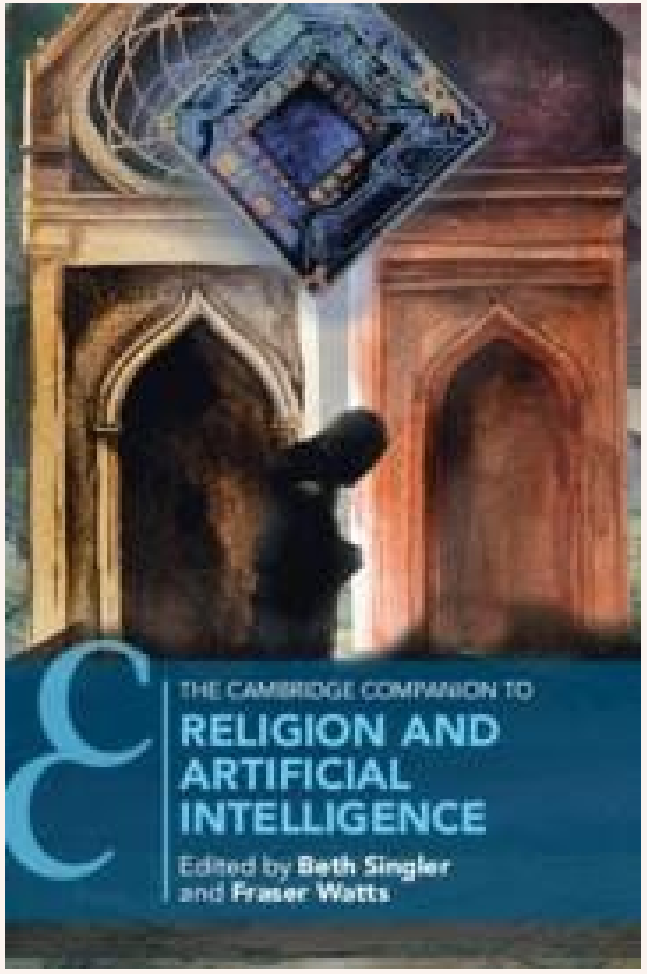
  System of rules that tells us what we can and cannot do

  1. Laws are enforced by a set of institutions
  2. Legal acts conform to the law
  3. Moral acts conform to what an individual believes is the right belief of right and wrong

Some Related Books







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Religious and Key Ethical Principles in AI

Religious Tradition	Key Ethical Principles in AI	Examples/Insights
Islam	- Justice ('adl), mercy (Rahmah), Trustworthiness (amanah), Benevolence and Kindness (Ihsan), Truthfulness (benar)	- Islamic ethics advocate a virtue-based approach, promoting justice and preventing harm.
	- Community welfare and intentionality	- AI should align with the Maqāṣid hierarchy (objectives of Islamic law) to ensure ethical use
Christianity	- Human dignity and stewardship	-Evangelical leaders emphasize transparency, accountability, and justice in AI use to respect human rights.
	- Accountability for ethical AI	- AI should enhance human capability without dehumanizing or infringing on fundamental rights.
Buddhism	- Compassion, non-harm, and mindfulness	- The Five Precepts guide ethical programming for fairness, transparency, and societal well-being.
	- Mindful engagement with technology	- Encourages thoughtful use of AI to mitigate over-dependence and promote mental health

References List
1. "Faith and the Ethics of Artificial Intelligence: A Postsecular Perspective," LinkedIn article by Lee Kirre, October 28, 2024.
2. "Divine Alignment: A Survey-Based Study on How Religion Influences Expectations for AI Alignment," Master's Thesis by Mert Can Yilmaz, Department of Theology, Spring 2023.

Fikir & Zikir

Islamic contributions to science were rooted in a culture that valued the pursuit of knowledge (ʿilm) as both a religious and intellectual duty. The Qur'an, Islam's central text, repeatedly urges believers to engage in inquiry, reflection, and observation of the natural world — for example, verses that call on humans to "reflect on the creation of the heavens and the earth" (Qur'an 3:190-191). This religious emphasis inspired Muslim scholars during the Golden Age (8th-14th centuries) to advance fields such as medicine, mathematics, astronomy, and philosophy, integrating scientific exploration with spiritual purpose.

Impact of Islam on Science: Contributions of Muslim Scientists During the Golden Age

Medicine: Avicenna and Al-Razi





Astronomy: Al-Battani and Ibn al-Haytham

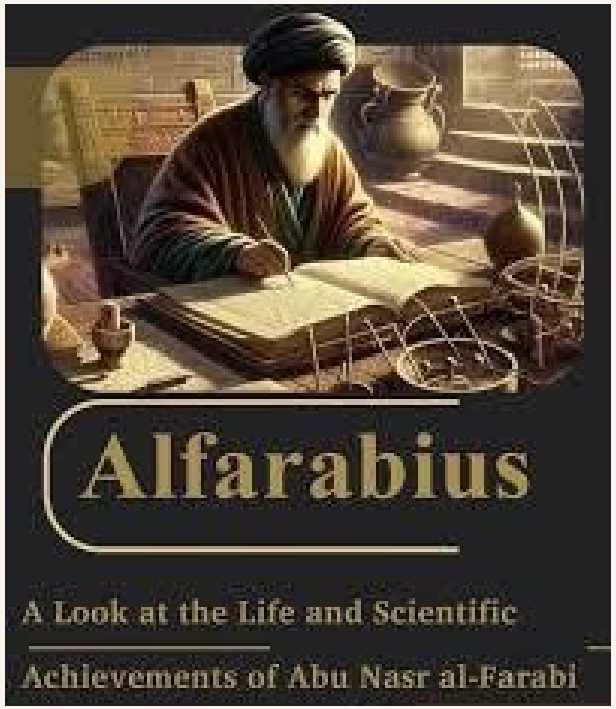




https://sahilonline.org/the-impact-of-islam-on-science-contributions-of-muslim-scientists-during-the-golden-age

Impact of Islam on Science: Contributions of Muslim Scientists During the Golden Age

Philosophy and Science: Al-Farabi and Ibn Rushd



Mathematics: Al-Khwarizmi





Chemistry: Jabir ibn Hayyan



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Muslim scientists during the Islamic Golden Age contributed greatly to science, philosophy, mathematics, and chemistry. Their work was not only scientific but also guided by religious and ethical values (e.g., seeking knowledge as a form of worship, using science for human benefit).

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AI Innovation Ecosystems: Overview

- Concept widely used in innovation management.
- Originates from biological ecosystems but applied in organizational, digital, and socio-technical contexts.
- Useful for understanding how actors interact, compete, and cooperate.
- An ecosystem means an interconnected environment where different actors depend on and influence each other

Organisational Perspective

- Organizations operate within and can shape ecosystems.
- Innovation success partly depends on the surrounding ecosystem.
- Helps develop strategy and identify growth opportunities.
- Example: IBM's rise and decline in the PC ecosystem (Moore, 1993).

"Success is not just about internal resources but about how well a company positions itself within and adapts to its broader ecosystem"

Types of Innovation Ecosystems

- *Business ecosystem*
- *Digital ecosystem*
- *Knowledge ecosystem*
- *National/City-level nnovation ecosystems*

Often organised around technology platforms & “keystone leaders”..

So, what about AI ecosystems?

Key Characteristics of Ecosystems

- *Evolutionary change (birth, expansion, leadership, self-renewal/death).*
- *Co-evolution & interdependence among actors.*
- *Openness – new entrants possible, incumbents must adapt.*
- *Mutual learning & networked relationships.*
- *Multiple layers: individuals, organizations, systems, landscapes.*

Why It Fits AI

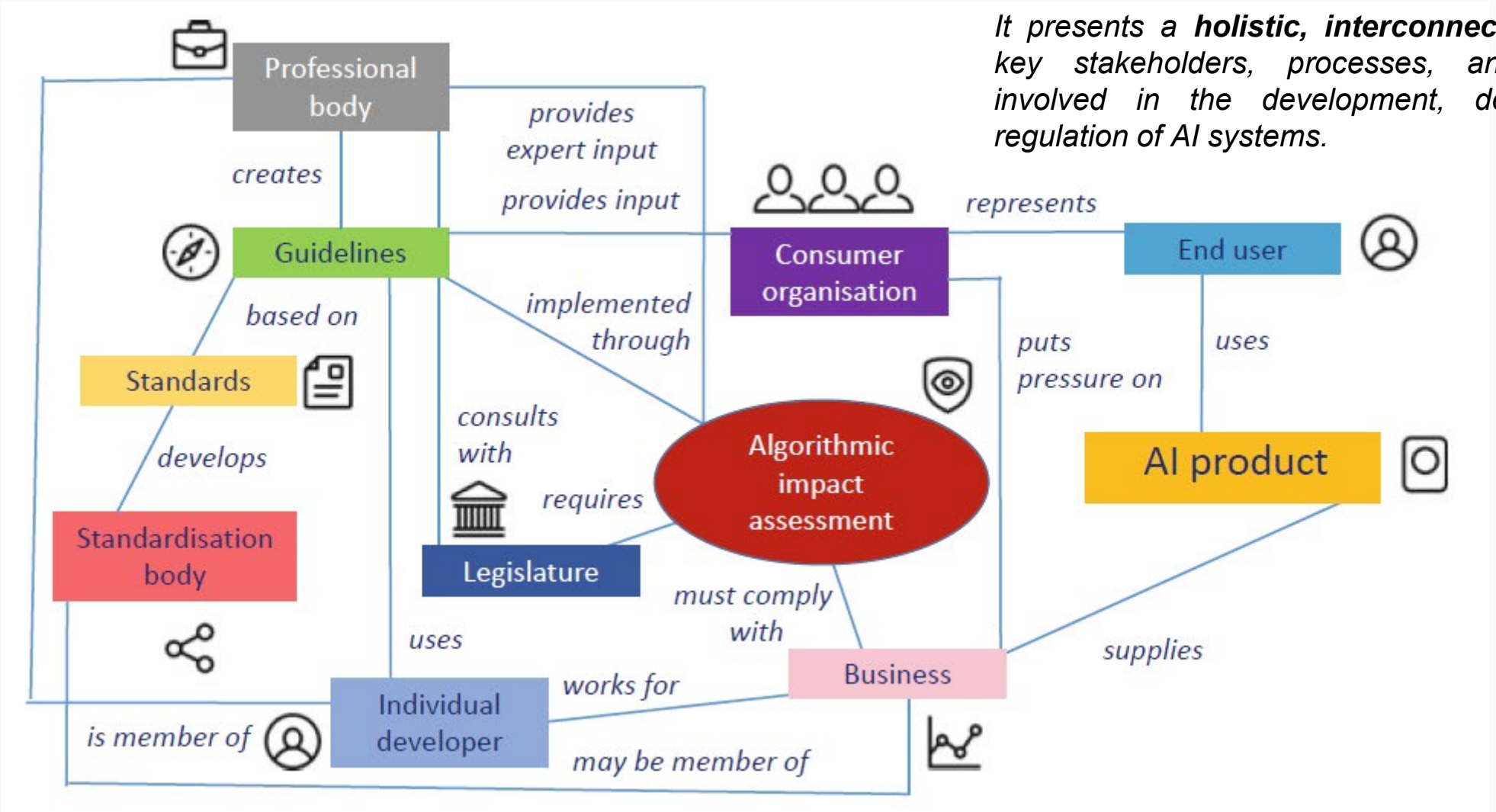
- Many actors & stakeholders.
- Complex, unpredictable interactions.
- Mutual dependence without total fragility.
- Co-evolving towards common and competing goals.

Why Ecosystem Fits AI

- Many actors & stakeholders.
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Systems view of the AI ecosystem

*It presents a **holistic, interconnected map** of the key stakeholders, processes, and relationships involved in the development, deployment, and regulation of AI systems.*



Systems view of stakeholders and activities to implement an algorithmic impact assessment

Purpose of Ecosystems in AI

Highlight ethical issues in AI

- Shows how features of AI (e.g., bias, opacity, autonomy) can create ethical risks and the need for mitigation.

Map the innovation ecosystem

- Helps us see the relevant parts of the AI ecosystem: professional bodies, legislators, businesses, consumers, and users.

Provide a mitigation strategy

- Emphasizes the role of Algorithmic Impact Assessments (AIAs) / Risk Assessments to identify and reduce risks.

Resonate with decision-makers

- Makes the discussion relevant not only for developers but also for business leaders and policymakers who must balance innovation and regulation.

Show complexity and interdependence

- Illustrates how both human actors (developers, regulators, consumers) and non-human actors (AI systems, standards, assessments) interact in a web of accountability.

Human Flourishing & Capabilities Approach

Goal:

Focus on cultivating human flourishing via measurable guidance.

Approach:

Martha Nussbaum's Capabilities Approach offers a structured framework for assessing what humans need to thrive.

Nussbaum's Ten Central Capabilities

1. **Life** – Living a full, normal lifespan.
2. **Bodily Health** – Having good health, adequate food, and shelter.
3. **Bodily Integrity** – Freedom of movement and security from violence.
4. **Senses, Imagination, and Thought** – Ability to think, imagine, and use one's mind freely.
5. **Emotions** – Capacity to form emotional attachments and feel love, grief, etc.
6. **Practical Reason** – Ability to plan life according to one's own values.
7. **Affiliation** – Being able to interact socially and live with respect and dignity.
8. **Other Species** – Connection and concern for animals and the natural world.
9. **Play** – Engaging in recreation and enjoyment.
10. **Control over One's Environment** – Political participation and control over personal property and work.

AI Ecosystem Human Flourishing

Purpose	Strengths	Challenges
Guiding ethical design	Offers clear categories for assessing needs	Hard to quantify multidimensional traits
Measuring well-being	Useful economic indicators for some capabilities	Limited in capturing holistic flourishing